

SECTION B – WRITTEN QUESTIONS (Total: 80 marks)

Answer **ALL** questions in this section. Marks are indicated at the end of each question. Together they are worth 80% of the total marks for this examination.

Question 1 (13 marks – approximately 23 minutes)

- (a) According to Porter's value chain model, list **FOUR** types of support activities with **ONE** example for each type.
(6 marks)
- (b) Define the term "real-time data". Explain why accountants should be aware of real-time data and the benefits it will bring.
(4 marks)
- (c) State **THREE** common types of cloud deployment models used in cloud computing.
(3 marks)

Question 2 (16 marks – approximately 29 minutes)

Imagine that you are going to set up a personal business and sell trendy European household accessories via a well-known e-marketplace that has more than 2 million active users.

Required:

- (a) Describe any **THREE** planning activities that should be completed before running your e-commerce business.
(6 marks)
- (b) Use an e-commerce example to demonstrate each of the following pricing strategies used to attract customers to buy your products:
 - (i) psychological pricing;
(2 marks)
 - (ii) bundle pricing; and
(2 marks)
 - (iii) price-match guarantees.
(2 marks)
- (c) Justify why the e-commerce type of your business could be classified as consumer-to-consumer (C2C).
(4 marks)

Question 3 (16 marks – approximately 29 minutes)

- (a) Analyse each of the following situations of a point-of-sales (POS) system and apply an appropriate input control to prevent each of them from happening again. Justify your answers with explanations.
- (i) The VIP code of Customer X was used and applied to a sales transaction of Customer Y.
(3 marks)
 - (ii) A salesperson input the wrong discount rate in a sales transaction, which resulted in selling an item at a discounted price that was far below its unit cost.
(3 marks)
 - (iii) A customer service representative officer accepted and recorded a returned item which had not been kept and sold by the company.
(3 mark)
- (b) State any TWO advantages of implementing segregation of duties among employees using information systems.
(4 marks)
- (c) Contrast on the operation of symmetric and asymmetric key encryption.
(3 marks)

Question 4 (18 marks – approximately 32 minutes)

- (a) Interpret how information can assist an organisation in achieving the following matters:
- (i) reducing uncertainties; (2 marks)
 - (ii) supporting problem-solving; and (2 marks)
 - (iii) becoming a potential revenue source. (2 marks)
- (b) Justify the necessity of using external information by tactical-level management. (4 marks)
- (c) State and describe any TWO types of reports that can be generated by a management information system (MIS). (3 marks)
- (d) Define the term "online analytical processing". (2 marks)
- (e) Demonstrate how to form a data cube for a regional cost analysis with some of the data fields as shown below. You are required to select and label which field should be used for each of the three dimensions (x-axis, y-axis and z-axis) in the data cube.
- Data fields: branch, cost type, department, period (month-year), region and amount. (3 marks)

Question 5 (17 marks – approximately 31 minutes)

- (a) Imagine that you are a system accountant in a local jewellery company. Recently, the senior management of the company has decided to replace its legacy point-of-sales (POS) system which has been used for 15 years.

Required:

- (i) Describe any TWO responsibilities of an IT steering committee and explain why it is necessary to let the company's IT steering committee discuss and endorse this IT project. (5 marks)
- (ii) Apart from economic feasibility, state and describe any THREE other types of feasibility factors that should be analysed for this IT project. (6 marks)
- (b) There are many providers of POS systems in the market, with their systems differing in functions and system cost. It is usually a challenging task to know which system suits the company most and whether that system is affordable.

Required:

Determine any TWO methods which could assist the project team in finding suitable and affordable POS systems for further consideration. Justify your answer with explanation.

(6 marks)

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